SOCIOCULTURAL FALSE BELIEF #2 · FAMILY TRADITIONS AND HERITAGE

"Asking for help is a sign of weakness."

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Where it often comes from

Families and cultures that prize self-reliance, whether through farm life, immigrant struggle, military service, or hard times, often teach that needing help is shameful. Children who watched parents never ask learn to white-knuckle through illness, money problems, and sorrow alone.

What Scripture teaches

Solomon observes, "Two are better than one… For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!" Paul says that the parts of the body that seem weaker are indispensable, and tells us to "carry one another's burdens." Moses needed Aaron and Hur to hold up his arms, and Jesus Himself was helped by Simon of Cyrene. The psalmist prays, "You are my helper and deliverer." God designed us to need Him and each other. Asking for help is wisdom, not weakness.

> *"Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"* (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

Also see

> "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ" (Galatians 6:2).

> "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable" (1 Corinthians 12:22).

> "But I am poor and needy; may the Lord think of me. You are my helper and deliverer; O my God, do not delay" (Psalm 40:17).

> "Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed" (Proverbs 15:22).

Common self-statements

- Real adults handle things alone.
- If I ask, I look weak.
- We never needed anyone.
- I do not want to be a burden.
- Asking means I have failed.
- I should be able to manage.

Common logical errors

- Should statements: Insisting that I should never need help.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Seeing myself as either strong or needy.
- Mind reading: Assuming others will think less of me.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling embarrassed and concluding that asking is wrong.

Challenging questions

- Who in my family never asked for help, and what did it cost them?

- How do I feel about someone who asks me for help?
- What does Scripture say about the strength of a body made of many parts?
- What am I struggling with alone right now?
- What is one small request I could make?
- What would it be like to let someone help?

Truth summary

> Needing help is part of how God made me. Asking is wise, humble, and strong, and it lets others use their gifts. I can ask for help and receive it with thanks.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Help
- Humility
- Pride
- Friendship
- Weakness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Pride
- Weak/Tired

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

Oh My Soul — Casting Crowns
Honest distress can coexist with faith and hope in God.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Asking for help is a sign of weakness"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Asking for help is a sign of weakness." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who never asked in my family?
- ☐ What do I carry alone?
- ☐ How do I see people who ask?
- ☐ What can I request?
- ☐ Who can help?
- ☐ How will I thank them?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Two are better than one.
- ☐ The weaker parts are indispensable.
- ☐ God is my helper.
- ☐ Asking is wisdom.
- ☐ Receiving lets others give.
- ☐ I was not made to do life alone.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9–10
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ Psalm 40:17
  "But I am poor and needy; may the Lord think of me. You are my helper and deliverer; O my God, do not delay."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] A request made: Each week, note one request for help and how it went.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Ecclesiastes 4:9–10 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Two are better than one, so I can ask for help.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Help" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- [ ] List what you carry alone. Write the tasks and worries you handle by yourself.
- [ ] Ask for one thing. Make a small, specific request.
- [ ] Say thank you. Receive help without apology.
- [ ] Help someone. Notice how it feels to be asked.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Asking for help is a sign of weakness": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A request made
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Asking for help is a sign of weakness.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, You made me to need You and others. Help me ask without shame and receive with gratitude. Thank You for those You send to help. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.